

FINANCIAL ADVISOR



SALARY

New financial advisor ★★☆☆☆

Senior financial advisor ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Employers include investment firms, banks, financial-services companies, and insurance companies • Demand for financial advice, particularly on retirement, is growing rapidly

JOB DESCRIPTION

Financial advisors help people plan their financial futures. They meet with clients, usually in person, to provide informed advice on a range of financial products and services, from pensions and investments to mortgages and tax-efficient savings. Taking into account a client's income and circumstances, they recommend products and strategies to help them meet their financial goals.



AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Economics • Law • Mathematics • Business studies • Accountancy • Finance • Information Technology (IT)



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Experience working in a sales, customer service, or finance role, and/or a degree in a related subject, is typically required.



LIFESTYLE Financial advisors work regular office hours but may need to meet clients during evenings and weekends. Many are self-employed.



LOCATION Advisors work from an office or from home. Traveling to meet with clients in their homes is a regular feature of the job.



THE REALITIES Dealing with multiple clients can be stressful, especially in hard economic times. It can take years to build a client base.

CAREER PATHS

To enter this career, applicants must pass a series of professional examinations and be registered by a regulatory body that ensures they give high-quality, unbiased advice. Qualified advisors can choose to provide general guidance to their clients or to specialize in one type of product, such as retirement or insurance.

ASSISTANT You can become a financial advisor without a degree by working as an assistant and training on the job. However, prior experience in banking or insurance is beneficial.



GRADUATE You will need a degree, preferably in finance or business management, to apply for entry-level financial advisor jobs with banks and independent financial-advice firms.

